

KARUNA KETAN

Game Designer

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in [karunaket](#) | Portfolio - karunaket.github.io/karunaketan

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game Designer focused on **Player Psychology, Economic Balancing, and crafting intuitive gameplay loops**. Expert in translating high-level creative pillars into actionable **GDDs**. Proven ability to bridge the gap between creative vision and engine implementation, focusing on **diegetic navigation** and designing **meaningful and highly engaging player experiences**.

PROJECTS

AOA: Space Scrap Smugglers (Co-op Simulator)

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

System & Level Designer - [Link](#)

- **System Design:** Authored master technical GDDs and core systemic loops to align production for a physics-driven experience.
- **Mechanics:** Designed physics-based tools that organically encourage team communication, reducing friction by **25%**.
- **Level Design:** Crafted top-down blockouts focused on spatial readability, improving navigation success by **40%**.
- **Onboarding:** Designed textless, **diegetic tutorials** achieving a **95% completion rate** without UI prompts.

Shattered Charms: Through the Veil (Action RPG)

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

Systems & Economy Designer - [Link](#)

- **Modular Progression:** Designed a **"Charm Fusion" matrix** replacing skill trees, increasing combat experimentation by **40%**.
- **Economy Balancing:** Modeled a **3-tier economy** in Excel, boosting side-quest engagement to **85%** through tuned drop rates.
- **Encounters:** Structured enemy encounters to reward synergy, resulting in a **30% increase** in player survival time.
- **UX Navigation:** Guided player psychology via **light-temperature shifts** (Safe/Warm Hub vs Danger/Cold Spokes).

Obstacle Assault (3D Platformer)

Jun 2025 – Jul 2025

Level Designer - [Link](#)

- **Tuning:** Iterated spatial metrics and **"coyote time"** across 15+ iterations to maintain a high-precision player Flow State.
- **Visual Framing:** Leveraged high-contrast lighting to frame checkpoints, reducing frustration and increasing player motivation.

EXPERIENCE

FatCatPlay Game Studio

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Contract Game Designer

- Spearheaded **technical documentation** and core systemic loops for unreleased physics-driven PC titles.
- Balanced enemy AI behavior trees for *MegaDrift* (IGDC 2024 & 2025), utilizing data to **optimize difficulty curves**.
- Refined top-down level layouts and gameplay flow through continuous, **player-focused playtesting**.

Freelance Game Designer

2023 – 2025

Systems & Economy Consultant

- Partnered with indie developers to translate creative concepts into actionable **System Blueprints** and balanced economies.
- Specialized in mathematical modeling in Excel to ensure sustainable progression and player retention hooks.
- Conducted comprehensive **Game Deconstructions** to identify market trends and optimize mechanical pillars.

Akiyam Solutions

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

Game Design Intern

- **Pipeline Optimization:** Reduced **design-to-implementation cycles by 20%** through technical flowcharts and One-Page Briefs.
- **Level Design:** Engineered **spatial metrics** and graybox layouts, increasing onboarding retention to **92%** based on data.

DESIGN SKILLS & TOOLS

Design: System Design, Economy Balancing, Level Blockouts, Player Psychology, Mechanic Deconstruction, Technical GDD Authoring.

Software: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Unity, Microsoft Excel (Modeling), Miro, Notion, Figma, Google Workspace.

Technical: Version Control (Git, Perforce), Technical Flowcharts, C++, XML/JSON Data Structuring.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science and Engineering

KPR Institute of Engineering & Technology

2022 – 2026

Tamil Nadu, India